About The Author

Alfred Tennyson, 1st Baron Tennyson (6 August 1809 – 6 October 1892) was a British poet. He was the Poet Laureate of Great Britain and Ireland during much of Queen Victoria's reign and remains one of the most popular British poets. Tennyson excelled at penning short lyrics, such as "Break, Break, Break", "The Charge of the Light Brigade", "Tears, Idle Tears", and "Crossing the Bar". He wrote verses on classical mythology such as Ulysses, Idylls of the King and Tithonus. Tennyson's use of the musical qualities of words to emphasise his rhythms and meanings is sensitive.

Glossary

drink life to the lees – drink to the very last drop; here 'live life to the fullest'

scudding – moving rapidly because of the wind

Hyades – a group of stars in the constellation Taurus often associated with rain

vext – (past tense of 'vex') upset

to rust unburnish'd – to let go waste, without being used

three suns – three long years

Telemachus – son of Ulysses

smite – strike

furrow – mark made in the water by the ship

baths – outer ocean or river that the Greeks believed to surround the flat earth

Happy Isles – a fortunate island situated in the Atlantic Ocean, popularly known as Greek Paradise

Achilles – the greatest of Greek warriors (as an infant his mother dipped into the river Styx, which made him invulnerable everywhere but the feet by which she held him)

1. Complete the summary of the poem, choosing words from the list given below.

Lines 1 to 32

Ulysses is (1) _____ to discharge his duties as a (2) _____, as he longs for (3) _____. He is filled with an (4) _____ thirst for (5) _____ and wishes to live life to the (6) _____. He has travelled far and wide gaining (7) _____ of various places, cultures, men and (8) _____. He recalls with

12th General_English_Unit_4_B_Poem.indd 130 22-02-2020 14:50:24